

Opening a .reg file in the traditional tree structure will immediately reveal any inconsistencies in the syntax, while enabling you to add and delete values without being too careful to follow the syntax that needs to be followed when working with the .reg file in text mode.

3.2 Registry Trackers

Registry trackers are tools that enable you to view interactions with the Registry in real time. Such tools become very useful in troubleshooting and pinpointing application activity and interaction with the Registry. Registry Monitor and MultiMon are two such Registry tracking tools.

3.2.1 Registry Monitor

Much like a CPU monitor, Registry Monitor continuously monitors interaction with the Registry. It captures, in real-time, information regarding applications accessing the Registry, reading from it and writing to it.

Registry monitor is downloadable from www.sysinternals.com/Utilities/Regmon.html.

This is a standalone .exe application. Using the menu and toolbar buttons, monitoring can be turned on or off and event capturing disabled. During Registry monitoring, the entries being captured can scroll through too fast for the eye. A useful feature controls the speed of the scrolling view, which can be slowed down to allow for online inspection of the entries, and the contents can be saved to an ASCII file for “offline” analysis.

There are usually many legal calls to the registry that Registry Monitor captures. These can number in the hundreds in a very short span of time, and can be daunting to wade through when trying to track down a specific problem. Registry Monitor has an